

TV HIGHLIGHTS

Olympics: Team figure skating, 4 a.m., 5:35 a.m., 7:35 a.m., USA
Olympics: Opening ceremony, 2 p.m., 8 p.m. (replay), NBC
Golf: PGA Phoenix Open, 3:30 p.m., Golf
NBA: Heat-Celtics, 7:30 p.m., NBCSB
Men's college basketball: UConn-St. John's, 8 p.m., Fox
Listings, C8

Sports

THE BOSTON GLOBE FRIDAY, FEBRUARY 6, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS

Coach of the Year goes to Vrabel again

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

SAN FRANCISCO — Mike Vrabel added some hardware to his collection, taking home the Coach of the Year award Thursday night at the annual NFL Honors ceremony.

Vrabel received 19 first-place votes, edging out the 16 for first-year Jaguars coach Liam Coen. The other finalists were Ben Johnson (Bears), Mike Macdonald (Seahawks), and Kyle Shanahan (49ers). Vrabel has now won the award twice.

This honor is well deserved for Vrabel, who helped restore the organization with stability and

VRABEL, Page C2



Adam Vinatieri, whose signature kick propelled the Patriots to a victory in Super Bowl XXXVI, was elected to the Hall of Fame.

Vinatieri elected to Hall of Fame

He'll be third kicker enshrined in Canton

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

SAN FRANCISCO — A couple of weeks ago, Adam Vinatieri did his best to keep his mind off of the pending decision on his Pro Football Hall of Fame candidacy.

"Maybe it happens," he thought. "Maybe it doesn't."

Last year, when he first became eligible for the Hall, Vinatieri was hopeful he would be among the inductees head-

ed to Canton, Ohio. He was voted one of the 15 finalists, only to later be disappointed by a phone call informing him he wasn't going to be enshrined.

So, when that time of year rolled around again, Vinatieri tried not to think about whether he would be receiving that dreaded phone call.

"I look at that list and I'm like, 'My God, how do you cut that down to four or five guys?'" he said. "It's a pretty amazing list."

This year, Vinatieri received a coveted knock on the door. Hall of Fame kicker Morton Andersen delivered the

VINATIERI, Page C2

New England's Disrespect Card back in play, from Hall of Fame snubs to 'Patriot for life' Tom Brady not having a dog in Super Bowl fight. **Shaughnessy, A1**

TARA SULLIVAN



SUPER BOWL LX PATRIOTS VS. SEAHAWKS Sunday, 6:30 p.m., NBC, Peacock



NFL hopes Bad Bunny will expand global reach



SAN FRANCISCO — When the NFL chose Bad Bunny as this year's Super Bowl half-time performer, the blowback was swift and predictable. From a White House that wants to forget that

Puerto Ricans are, in fact, Americans, to those who willfully ignore that Spanish (the artist's preferred language for his performances) is the second-most common language spoken across the United States, Bad Bunny quickly became the flashpoint in an ongoing culture war, cast as some divisive figure who didn't belong on the sports world's biggest stage.

Those detractors couldn't be more wrong. Bad Bunny, born Benito Antonio Martínez Ocasio, is a Spanish-language rapper who won a Grammy for best album and one of the world's most streamed artists. He was Spotify's top artist for the fourth time in 2025. As he stood on a stage for a pre-Super Bowl press conference Thursday, moderators informed him he was the No. 1 artist in China.

In the universal language of music, he is

SULLIVAN, Page C3



GREG M. COOPER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Veteran center Garrett Bradbury joined the Patriots this season and brought over an offensive line fine system for "infractions" from Minnesota.

FINE LINE

Money matters as players pay for offenses committed

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

SANTA CLARA, Calif. — Inside the offensive line's room at Gillette Stadium, there's a teacher's bell on center Garrett Bradbury's desk.

"When the bell is rung, a fine is given out," Bradbury said.

After helping organize weekly dinners for his position group, Bradbury spearheaded the introduction of another tradition popular among offensive

lines across the NFL. He established a fine system in which the linemen are required to pay up if they commit one of the three dozen or so agreed-upon offenses.

"It was kind of hard to implement to start the year," Bradbury said. "Guys were like, 'Why are you taking my money?'"

Bradbury, who signed a two-year contract in March, consulted a few of his ex-teammates in Minnesota to compile a list of their infractions. He then

made a few tweaks, before unveiling the finalized rules during Patriots training camp.

So, how exactly does it work?

Actions that can lead to fines are wide-ranging. Some are within a player's control. Plenty are not. Some relate to performance. Others don't involve football at all.

If you're inactive on game day? Fine. If coach Mike Vrabel awards you a game ball? Fine. If you're

PATRIOTS, Page C2



MIKE COPPOLA/GETTY IMAGES

Grammy-winning Puerto Rican rapper Bad Bunny was the No. 1 artist in China.

MORE OLYMPICS

Stick to plan
US star Shiffrin still to ski only in slalom and giant slalom. **C6**

Who'll win?
Preview, predictions for Team USA for all 16 sports. **C7**

MORE SPORTS



Payroll cut
Celtics under luxury tax after three trades at NBA deadline. **C4**

Set for WBC
Ten Red Sox to play in tournament across eight teams. **C5**

THE 2026 WINTER OLYMPICS



PETR DAVID JOSEK/ASSOCIATED PRESS

First-time Olympian Joy Dunne scored for the US women's hockey team in a 5-1 win over Czechia. Coverage, **C6**

Olympians stress unity at the Games

By Matt Porter
GLOBE STAFF

MILAN — In a city swept up by fashion, the dominant color in the Olympic lead-up appears to be gray.

It has enveloped the skies, which have dumped chilly rain and drizzle on the streets with little respite.

While the pink-and-orange alpenglow may wash over the far-flung mountain sites of the historically widespread 2026 Winter Olympics, there is a dark cloud in the city. One that hovers over Team USA.

Protests rocked Milan last weekend following news that US Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) agents will accompany the American

OLYMPICS, Page C6